

vision**2**learn

Understanding Autism

Unit 1

Learning
outcomes



Unit 1 - Introduction to autism

Learning outcomes / Assessment criteria

- 1 Understand what is meant by 'autism'.
 - 1.1 Describe the following social and communication disorders:
 - Autistic spectrum condition
 - Asperger syndrome
 - High-functioning autism (HFA).
 - 1.2 Explain how autism can be considered as a spectrum condition.
 - 1.3 Explain why it is important to recognise that autism is a lifelong condition.
- 2 Know theories that relate to autism.
 - 2.1 Outline the following theoretical models in relation to identifying autism:
 - Kanner
 - Asperger
 - Wing and Gould.
 - 2.2 Explain how the terms 'neurodiverse' and 'neurotypical' are used in relation to autism.

3 Know how autism is diagnosed.

- 3.1 Outline the current guidelines for the diagnosis of autism in the UK.
- 3.2 Describe the **difficulties** surrounding the diagnosis of autism in relation to:
 - formal diagnosis
 - the range of different diagnosis on the spectrum.
- 3.3 Give reasons why people may be reluctant to seek a diagnosis.
- 3.4 Explain why it is important for individuals to have a formal diagnosis.
- 3.5 State the **prevalence** of autism in the UK.

4 Understand the characteristics that may be present in individuals with autism.

- 4.1 Describe the main **characteristics** found in individuals with autism.
- 4.2 Describe how these characteristics can vary from individual to individual.
- 4.3 Outline what is meant by the '**triad of impairments**'.
- 4.4 Identify positive and negative points of the triad of impairments.

5 Know about conditions that commonly co-occur with autism.

- 5.1 Explain the following conditions that may co-occur with autism:
 - mental ill-health
 - learning disability
- 5.2 Describe **other conditions** that may co-occur with autism.
- 5.3 Describe the concerns that can arise from these co-occurring conditions.

- 6 Understand common misconceptions surrounding autism.
- 6.1 Describe how attitudes and lack of understanding can compound the difficulties of individuals with autism.
- 6.2 Give examples of how autism can be misrepresented in the media.
- 6.3 Describe how discrimination against individuals with autism can occur inadvertently in society.